Branard O'Niel (Niel) Blackwell

PROJECT CONTROLS | SCHEDULING | COST ENGINEERING | ESTIMATING

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Project controls, scheduling, cost engineering and estimating professional with extensive experience supporting U.S. Department of Energy (DOE), National Nuclear Security Administration (NNSA), commercial nuclear power generation, EPC and construction programs. Background includes construction and modification scheduling, multidiscipline cost estimating, integrated life-cycle cost estimating, earned value management, procurement and cost/price analysis, budget development and forecasting, risk analysis, asset/property management, work planning and field engineering. Experienced with complex nuclear and government programs at Savannah River Site and Plant Vogtle, with a long record of cross-functional project support, problem solving and team leadership.

CORE EXPERTISE

Project Controls • Project Scheduling • Cost Engineering & Estimating • Earned Value Management
DOE / NNSA / Nuclear Programs • EPC & Construction • Baseline Development • Work Planning
Procurement & Supply Chain • Cost & Price Analysis • Budgeting & Forecasting • Risk Analysis
Asset / Property Management • Project Planning • Multidiscipline Estimating • Team Leadership & Mentoring
Tools: Primavera P3/P6 • WinEst • Microsoft Office • Maximo • Metrics analysis software • Deltek Acumen Fuse (working knowledge)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2023-2024 | Aecon-Wachs

Project Scheduler | Contractor to DOE/NNSA

- Developed all-discipline construction and modification schedules supporting Aecon-Wachs D&R activities and temporary HVAC modifications for the proposed NNSA/DOE joint project to convert the decommissioned Mixed Oxide Fuel Fabrication Facility (MOX) at Savannah River Site (SRS) to a plutonium-pit production facility.

2020 | CRC Technologies Inc.

Project Mechanical Estimator | Contractor to DOE/NNSA

- Developed all-discipline construction and modification estimates for CD-1 funding in support of the proposed NNSA/DOE project to convert the decommissioned MOX facility at SRS to a plutonium-pit production facility.

2017-2020 | Pro2Serve

Mission Planning Division | Contractor to DOE

- Identified and defined logistical relationships between programs and work elements, translating information into work plans and cost estimates.
- Developed 5-year, 10-year and life-cycle planning products ranging from strategic/logistical plans to budget- and forecast-oriented plans.
- Supported the Integrated Life-Cycle Cost Estimate (ILCE), including scope, schedule and estimates for work across the installation.
- Supported PMCD/OIP program implementation and execution through program/project management, project formulation, mission verification, categorization (construction, capital asset and operations) and baseline development.

2016-2017 | Bass Consulting Group | Aiken, SC

Senior Estimator - Mechanical Scope, AECOM/DOE Proposal

- Provided senior mechanical estimating support for a DOE liquid waste proposal.

2007-2015 | Southern Nuclear - Vogtle Nuclear Plant | Waynesboro, GA

Senior Estimator / Work Planning Supervisor | Cost & Scheduling

- Supported Vogtle Nuclear Plant Units 1 & 2 power uprate work, Part 73 security upgrades, Units 1 & 2 Digital Feed Water Control System upgrades, plant modifications and major site projects.
- Developed and maintained project baselines, construction estimates, manpower utilization plans and Primavera P6 schedules for the approximately $80M Vogtle 1 & 2 Uprate Project and related site upgrades.
- Supervised Williams contract work planners.
- Supported EPC organizational, procurement and administrative activities and a field engineer mechanical assignment.

1990-2005 | Westinghouse Savannah River Company (U.S. DOE) | Aiken, SC

Lead Administrative Analyst - Asset Management / Property Management Group

- Developed the WSRC Subcontract Property Program and procedures for managing Government Furnished Property provided to subcontractors and universities.
- Developed and implemented an Asset Management Export Control Program with checks and balances designed to prevent inadvertent release of classified or sensitive data and proprietary site-designed components or equipment.
- Developed and managed the WSRC/DOE Exchange Sale Program for trade-in of DOE-owned material and equipment, with revenues reported as greatly exceeding (800%) the traditional ROI of government-sponsored excess sales.

Manager - Procurement Cost Engineering Group, Procurement & Materials Management Department

- Performed and supervised fair-cost procurement estimates and cost/price analysis for fabricated materials, engineered equipment and components, construction subcontracts and services.
- Developed a database of actual contract costs for use by engineering, procurement and site estimating.
- Established field offices supporting procurement construction subcontract administrators and developed site policy/procedures for construction subcontract design changes.
- Managed the WSRC Procurement Card Program and the START Program used to evaluate supplier delivery and performance metrics.

1989-1990 | Chas. T. Main, Inc. - Government Services Division | Charlotte, NC

Principal Estimator and Field Office Manager

- Prepared and supervised multidiscipline construction estimates and prepared/conducted EOC presentations to engineering and project management.
- Established and managed the New Ellenton, SC field office, serving as the HR interface and technical lead estimator for site-assigned employees.

1967-1989 | Southern Company Services - The Southern Company

Lead Field Cost Engineer - Nuclear Plant Field Engineering Support Group | Plant Alvin Vogtle, Waynesboro, GA

- Produced field design and as-built estimates for joint Georgia Power and Bechtel projects and prepared cost-impact-to-budget reports.
- Coordinated HR/Employee Concerns Programs for a joint Southern Company/Bechtel 35-member field office with the Birmingham home office.

Cost Engineer - Cost Engineering Group | Birmingham, AL

- Provided estimating support for retrofit projects for Georgia Power, Gulf Power and Mississippi Power.
- Served as lead estimator for the EPRI Breeder Reactor estimate and the Plant Vogtle Pollution Control Bond issue release.
- Partnered with procurement representatives on RFQ and bid proposal negotiations, interfacing with suppliers, architects, engineers and project management.

Co-op Student-Designer - Mechanical Design Department | Birmingham, AL

- Progressed through drafting and designer job families while assigned to the home office and field support groups for fossil-fuel generating plants in the Southern Company system.

EDUCATION & ADDITIONAL STUDY

- Bachelor of Arts, University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL
- Graduate study - MBA program, Samford University, Birmingham, AL
- Graduate study - MDiv program, Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary, Wake Forest, NC
- Law studies, Birmingham School of Law, Birmingham, AL
- Ministerial studies, Samford University, Birmingham, AL | U.S. Army Chaplain Candidate Program

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

- American Association of Cost Engineers (AACE) - CCE
- National Contract Management Association (NCMA) - CACM
- National Property Management Association (NPMA)

PUBLICATION

"Financing Nuclear Power Plant Pollution Control Facilities." AACE Mid-Winter Symposium, New Orleans, LA, 1986.